

HTTP Status Codes

How to interpret HTTP responses in API testing.

Overview

HTTP codes are grouped into 1xx informational, 2xx success, 3xx redirection, 4xx client error and 5xx server error.

Essential QA codes

Validate 200, 201 and 204 for success; 400, 401, 403, 404, 409, 422 and 429 for client scenarios; and 500, 502, 503 and 504 for server/dependency failures.

Test strategy

Do not validate the number alone. Check body, headers, contract, business rules, idempotency and sensitive-data exposure.

QA Tip

A correct status code does not guarantee a functionally correct response.

Official: <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTTP/Reference/Status>